What would a level-1 system for the personalized information policy look like? Every time new data is pushed into the corresponding Git repository, a script launches and goes through the data, searching for a couple of predefined patterns. As a monitor, the only thing it should do is return the corresponding rows and the found pattern to the team members that pushed the data. They can then decide for themselves whether they just broke the policy.

Once the Yellow team feels confident with its script, the team members could decide to turn it into a level 2 system by advancing with partial automation. That means they would install it, for instance, as a pre-commit Git hook inside the repositories where the data lives. Then, every time a person pushes new data into the repository, the checks will automatically run before the data flows into the system. The Yellow team might even decide to stop the commit by returning an error if the policy is not met.

Of course, because checking for personalized data isn't easy, this automated script could still be faulty. So the Yellow team would provide an override option on its first try.

A level 3+ autonomous *system* for this part would have an improved policy-checking script and no override option, possibly applying automated transformations to the personalized data to not stop the flow of the emitting team. This could include a pseudonymizer or a white-out function.

As you can see, it's easily possible to iterate through the stages quickly, have various checks at different levels depending on where the human bottleneck is, and consider the severity of governance rule breaks.

Summary

- Data governance aims to clarify processes, roles, policies, standards, and metrics, enabling effective derivation of business value from data.
- Data governance outcomes can be organized into a hierarchical structure, from strategic outcomes influencing the enterprise as a whole, to outcomes affecting local decisions.